

STUDENT ACTIVITIES

Loudoun County Public Schools (LCPS) recognize the benefits and the values students develop by participating in interscholastic, co-curricular, and extra-curricular activities as an extension of the education program.

Interscholastic, co-curricular, and extra-curricular activities are part of the educational program and are subject to school supervision and regulation. Student conduct at such activities is therefore governed by LCPS policies and the same rules for students will apply any time they are under school supervision. In addition, students are expected to display good sportsmanship in competitive activities, whether they are participants or spectators, and they shall conduct themselves in a manner demonstrating respect for persons and property.

Participation in interscholastic, co-curricular, and extra-curricular activities is a privilege. A student may be excluded from participating in these activities as part of a disciplinary action. Interscholastic, co-curricular, and extracurricular activities will be organized to avoid interrupting the instructional program and will not interfere with the student's required instructional activities.

A. Definitions

1. Interscholastic Activities. These activities are athletic or academic in nature and involve students competing with students from other schools. Interscholastic activities are offered by LCPS to students outside of the regular instructional school day. Examples of interscholastic activities include those sponsored by the Virginia High School League, including sports teams, publications/multimedia, creative writing, esports, theatre, debate, forensics, and yearbook.

2. Co-curricular Activities. These activities are optional and are an extension of the regular educational offerings as listed in the district program of studies. Examples of co-curricular activities include academic honor societies, advisory, student leadership organizations, school counseling student groups, course-related academic clubs and competitions, and fine arts-related performance groups.

3. Extra-curricular Activities. These activities are special interest groups organized by students and overseen by school staff offered to students outside of the regular instructional school day. Examples of extra-curricular activities include political, religious, community service, or recreational activities. Student participation is voluntary and is neither encouraged nor discouraged by the school.

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B. Eligibility

1. Interscholastic Activities. Eligibility to participate in interscholastic activities is determined by Virginia High School League (VHSL) which is an alliance of Virginia's public and approved non-boarding, non-public high schools that establishes standards for school activities and competitions (athletic and/or non-athletic). A student must be currently enrolled in five (5) credit subjects or their equivalent and must have passed five (5) credit subjects or their equivalent the previous semester. Interscholastic athletics are not a part of the program for middle or elementary school students, except that eighth-grade students who meet the requirements and who become 14 years of age by August 1 are eligible for sub varsity athletics at the high school they are zoned to attend.

2. Co-curricular Activities. Eligibility to participate in co-curricular activities shall be determined by each school and in compliance with requirements established by superior (i.e., regional, state, or national) organizations if such exist. Co-curricular activities shall be open to all students. Co-curricular activities must be sponsored by one or more professional staff members employed by LCPS.

3. Extra-curricular Activities. Activities must be approved by the principal of the school. A staff member will attend all meetings to monitor activities. Each activity may establish reasonable qualifications for membership and/or participation governed by the following guidelines:

- a. No activity, club, or other student group which unlawfully restricts its membership or operates as a secret society may be approved as a school activity nor shall it be permitted to engage in any activity within the school.
- b. No activity, club, or other student group may interfere with teaching and learning, disrupt the operation of school, promote unlawful activities or engage in acts of intimidation or harassment, or activities in violation of School Board policies and school rules.
- c. All extra-curricular-related student clubs and activities in high schools shall be conducted in compliance with the Equal Access Act (20 U.S.C. §§ 4071-4074), as applied on an individual school basis. All activities

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must be conducted in compliance with Title IX of the Education Amendments of 1972

For requirements concerning student participation as it relates to home instruction, see Policy 8080, Home Instruction, and Policy 8115, "Persons Who May Be Admitted Free."

C. Rules of Conduct and Disciplinary Action. The principal will authorize interscholastic, co-curricular, and extra-curricular activities and events. Students who participate are subject to reasonable rules of conduct and training. Violations of these rules will result in disciplinary actions ranging from conferences with school staff and the student and his/her parent(s) or guardian(s), to dismissal from participation.

1. Interscholastic and Co-curricular Activities. Students shall comply with the rules and regulations for participating in activities. Ejection from contests by an official, dismissal from a team, and other disciplinary actions short of dismissal from a team are outlined in the "Student Activities Handbook."

2. Extracurricular Activities. In the absence of a suspension or expulsion, and when appropriate to an offense, a student may be excluded from participation in some or all extra-curricular activities and/or attendance at school-sponsored events. Such exclusions may be for a fixed period of time or until assurances of acceptable behavior have been obtained.

The parent(s) or guardian(s) of any student removed from participation in interscholastic, co-curricular, extra-curricular activities and/or attendance at school sponsored events shall be notified. The principal's decision will be final and not appealable.

D. Funding

1. Funding of Interscholastic Activities. Funding of interscholastic activities is the responsibility of LCPS. LCPS General Operating Funds are used for coaching stipends, security, transportation, VHSL membership fees, and officials. The following items are not funded by the general operating funds for existing schools: uniforms, school branding, and minor equipment. Additional funding may come from school support organizations and school activity funds.

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2. Funding of Co-curricular Activities. Co-curricular activities aligned with stipended sponsorships per Policy 7316: Supplementary Pay: Athletic Coaches, Sponsors of Virginia High School League Activities (VHSL), Co-Curricular and Other Stipends may be funded by LCPS General Operating Funds. Co-curricular clubs/activities may also be additionally funded by school support organizations and school activity funds, comprised primarily of those monies derived from the co-curricular activities themselves, such as club dues, performances, special events, fundraisers, donations, etc. All funding of co-curricular activities must be approved by the appropriate content-area supervisor and occur in compliance with Policy 8010: Fundraising, Policy 4020: Student Fees and Charges, Policy 4020-REG: Student Fees and Charges, and Policy 4030: Non-Locally Funded Programs - Grants, and Policy 4030-REG: Non-Locally Funded Programs - Grants and Donations.

3. Funding of Extracurricular Activities. Extra-curricular activities are supported financially by school activity funds, comprised primarily of those monies derived from the extracurricular activities themselves, such as club dues, performances, special events, fundraisers, donations, etc. Additional funding may come from school support organizations. All funding of extracurricular activities must be approved by the building principal in conjunction with district-level administration as appropriate and occur in compliance with Policy 8010: Fundraising, Policy 4020: Student Fees and Charges, Policy 4020-REG: Student Fees and Charges, and Policy 4030: Non-Locally Funded Programs - Grants, and Policy 4030-REG: Non-Locally Funded Programs - Grants and Donations.

E. Addition and Deletion of Student Activities

1. Addition and Deletion of Interscholastic Activities. Approved interscholastic activities shall be listed on the Registry of Interscholastic Activities (the Registry) as either Virginia High School League (VHSL) Sponsored or Non-VHSL Sponsored Activities. LCPS staff shall be responsible for periodic evaluations of the factors as they pertain to adding, deleting, and/or maintaining interscholastic activities. Factors include, but are not limited to, equity, compatibility with VHSL policies and regulation, compliance with Title IX and other applicable laws, availability of practice and competition space, availability of same level competition locally or within our geographic region, demonstrated need/interest in the new activity, availability of staff, adequate administrative supervision, availability of transportation, and sustainability over time. Parents may also apply in writing to the principal to add or delete an activity on the Registry.

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- a. Recommendation by the Principal. The initial recommendation to add a VHSL activity or non-VHSL interscholastic activity to or remove a VHSL or non-VHSL interscholastic activity from the Registry shall be made by a current Loudoun County Public Schools high school principal after completing an assessment. The principal's recommendation will be forwarded to the Division Superintendent or designee. All recommendations must be submitted by August 1 for consideration of being added to the Registry for the following school year.
- b. Recommendation by the Division Superintendent. Upon receipt of the principal's recommendation to add an interscholastic activity to or delete an interscholastic activity from the Registry, the Division Superintendent or designee shall conduct an administrative review of the request and forward a recommendation to the School Board for consideration and action.
- c. Administrative Review. The administrative review will assess school and community benefits, the Title IX compliance implications and the potential capital and operational factors that will impact the district's ability to support the interscholastic activity, including startup costs (e.g. uniforms, facility availability, coaching staff, rental fees, etc.), and ongoing operational costs (e.g. uniforms, lighting, transportation, salaries, and other). The Division Superintendent or designee will have 60 working days from the time of receiving a request to conduct an administrative review of the request to add an interscholastic activity to or remove an interscholastic activity from the Registry and to submit their recommendation to the School Board.
- d. School Board Approval. The School Board will have the final decision to approve and fund a new addition to the Registry if funding for the addition is available at the time of the budget adoption. The School Board will have 60 working days from receipt of the recommendation to act upon the recommendation of the Division Superintendent. The decision of the School Board will be forwarded to the appropriate School Administrator(s).
- e. Legacy Activities. All interscholastic high school programs that were approved prior to the revision of Policy 8350, shall be incorporated under former policy 8-45 and be able to continue with the

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understanding that the parent organization must submit the Memorandum of Agreement, Annual Organization Budget, Current IRS EIN Information, Verification of State Corporation Status annually, and Holder of a Catastrophic and General Liability of Insurance Policy to the Supervisor of Athletics 60 days prior to the first competition of the current school year.

2. Addition and Deletion of Co-curricular Activities. The addition and deletion of co-curricular activities shall occur at the division level. Each co-curricular activity must be approved by the content area office and respective level director. The principal will assign a staff sponsor who will attend meetings and activities associated with the co-curricular activity within their school.

3. Addition and Deletion of Extra-curricular Activities. The addition and deletion of extra-curricular activities shall occur at the school level. Each extra-curricular activity must be approved by the principal and be assigned a staff sponsor who will attend meetings and activities associated with the extra-curricular activity.

[Former Policy 8-48 and Policy 8-45, also merged Policies 8-29, 8-46, 8-47, and 8-60]

Adopted: 9/13/76

Revised: 9/8/87, 6/22/93, 12/13/11, 1/22/19

Current Revision: 6/28/22

Legal Refs: Legal Refs: [§8.01-42.1](#) Code of Virginia; (Civil Action for Racial, Religious, or Ethnic Harassment); [22.1-79.3](#), Code of Virginia; [20 U.S.C. §§ 4071](#) and [7905](#).

Cross Refs: Policy [7316](#), Supplementary Pay: Athletic Coaches, Sponsors of Virginia High School League Activities (VHSL), Co-Curricular and Other Stipends, Policy [8080](#), Home Instruction, Policy [8115](#), Persons Who Are Admitted Free and Policy [8215](#), In-School Disciplinary Measures, Policy [8010](#), Fundraising, Policy [4020](#), Student Fees and Charges, Policy [4020-REG](#), Student Fees and Charges, and Policy [4030](#), Non-Locally Funded Programs - Grants, and Policy [4030-REG](#), Non-Locally Funded Programs - Grants and Donations